

2021 年3月公共英语三级真题

Section I Listening

(25 minutes)

Directions:

This section is designed to test your ability to understand spoken English. You will hear a selection of recorded materials, and you must answer the questions that accompany them. There are two parts in this section, Part A and Part B.

Remember, while you are doing the test, you should first put down your answers in your test booklet. At the end of the listening comprehension section, you will have 5 minutes to transfer your answers from your test booklet onto your ANSWER SHEET. If you have any questions, you may raise your hand now as you will not be allowed to speak once the test has started.

Now look at Part A in your test booklet.

Part A

Directions:

You will hear 10 short dialogues. For each dialogue, there is one question and four possible answers. Choose the correct answer A, B, C or D, and mark it in your test booklet. You will have 15 seconds to answer the question, and you will hear each dialogue only once.

1. What is the new benefit of green tea?

[A] Reducing cancers.

[B] Preventing strokes.

[C] Improving memory.

[D] Protecting the heart.

2. What does the man suggest the woman do?

[A] Finish her report.

[B] Have a short rest.

[C] Stand up to work.

[D] Adjust the screen.

3. What is the possible relationship between the two speakers?

[A] Husband and wife.

[B] Doctor and patient.

[C] Boss and secretary.

[D] Teacher and parent.

4. Why does the man eat out so often?

[A] He has no time to cook.

[B] He likes restaurant food.

[C] He has to treat his friends.

[D] He needs to do that for business.

5. What does the man think of the music?

[A] It is boring.

[B] It is relaxing.

[C] It is stimulating.

[D] It is discouraging.

6. What does the woman mean?

- [A] She did not hear what was shocking.
 [B] She is not sure how to solve the mystery.
 [C] She was not able to manage the project well.
 [D] She feels surprised how she could finish so early.
7. What does the woman's problem mainly concern?
 [A] Language ability. [B] Financial support.
 [C] Social contacts. [D] Cultural differences.
8. What does the woman think that the man did wrong?
 [A] He spent all day emailing. [B] He left his email page open.
 [C] He forgot to close the door. [D] He quarreled with his boss.
9. What does the woman think of the man's new suit?
 [A] It is expensive. [B] It is fashionable.
 [C] It is a good bargain. [D] It is the best choice.
10. Why did the woman's mother get annoyed with her father?
 [A] He fell asleep while watching TV.
 [B] He complained about her cooking.
 [C] He changed channels from time to time.
 [D] He stuck to his own favorite TV program.

Part B

Directions:

*You will hear four dialogues or monologues. Before listening to each one, you will have 5 seconds to read each of the questions which accompany it. While listening, answer each question by choosing A, B, C or D. After listening, you will have 10 seconds to check your answer to each question. You will hear the recording **only once***
Questions 11-13 are based on the following conversation.

11. What does Maggie want James to do?
 [A] To write a report. [B] To have lunch with her.
 [C] To have a talk with her. [D] To meet the boss at the airport.
12. When will the first meeting that James attends end?
 [A] 1 a.m. [B] 2 p.m.
 [C] 3 p.m. [D] 5 p.m.
13. Where do they decide to meet the next day?
 [A] At a cafe. [B] At the airport.
 [C] At the conference [D] On William Street.

Questions 14-17 are based on the following dialogue about Santa Catalina Island.

14. What does the man say about Catalina?
- [A] He has never heard of it before
[B] There is a film about Catalina
[C] It has appeared in many films.
[D] It is Los Angeles's main spot.
15. What is the distance between Catalina and Los Angeles?
- [A] 19 km. [B] 35 km [C] 90 km. [D] 300 km
16. What do we learn about Avalon?
- [A] It is known for ice cream. [B] It is famous for golf carts.
[C] It has many modern shops. [D] It has a small population.
17. How did the man tour Catalina?
- [A] In a bus. [B] In a cart.
[C] On a ferry. [D] On a plane

Questions 18-21 are based on the following interview with a volleyball coach

18. Who persuaded the man into coaching volleyball?
- [A] His boss. [B] His school.
- [C] His friends. [D] His students.
19. Where did the man learn how to coach volleyball?
- [A] From other coaches. [B] From his colleagues.
- [C] From a friend of his. [D] From a training class.
20. What sports did the man like best when he was in high school?
- [A] Golf. [B] Tennis.
- [C] Volleyball. [D] Basketball.
21. Why did the man like to be a volleyball coach?
- [A] He took it as a greater challenge. [B] He thought himself fit for the job.
- [C] He could earn an ample salary. [D] He could enjoy more leisure time.

Questions 22-25 are based on conversation about the current movie industry.

22. Why is there a drop in the box office?
- [A] Audiences are bored with films of a similar theme.
- [B] DVD business has won over most moviegoers.
- [C] There are too few new films produced a year.
- [D] People now have more spare time choices.

23. What does the man feel about today's theaters?

- [A] They are not clean. [B] They fail to provide food.
[C] They are not large enough. [D] They fail to entertain people.

24. What time is thought to be the best time for releasing many new movies?

- [A] At weekends [B] At film festivals.
[C] During the spring. [D] During the summer.

25. What does the man think of the current movie business?

- [A] He feels a great pity for it. [B] He feels disappointed with it.
[C] It is still working effectively. [D] It is falling into great trouble.

You now have 3 minutes to transfer your answers from your test booklet to ANSWER SHEET1.

That is the end of the listening comprehension section

Section II Reading

(50 minutes)

Part A

Directions:

Read the following two texts. Answer the questions on each text by choosing A, B, C or D. Mark your answers on ANSWER SHEET 1.

Text 1

The extraordinary rise of living alone is the biggest social change that we've neglected to identify, let alone examine.

Consider that in 1950, a mere 4 million Americans lived alone, making up only 9% of households. Back then, living alone was the most common in the Western states that attracted seasonal workingmen. And it was usually a short-lived stage on the road to a more conventional domestic life. Not anymore. According to the latest data, nearly 33 million Americans live alone, making up 28% of households, which means they are now tied with childless couples as the most important type, more common than the nuclear family, the multigenerational family and the roommate or group home. These aren't just temporary living situations: over a five-year period, people who live alone are more likely to remain in their current state than anyone else except married couples with children. They're concentrated in big cities throughout the country.

Living alone, being alone and feeling lonely are hardly the same, yet in recent years experts have mixed them up, raising fears that the rise of living alone signals the ultimate atomization of the modern world. In fact, there's little evidence that the rise of living alone is making more Americans lonely. According to the latest studies, what matters is not whether we live alone but whether we feel lonely. Divorced people often say there's nothing lonelier than living with the wrong person. Besides, people living alone compensate by becoming more socially active than those who live with others.

The truth is, today nearly everyone who lives alone chooses to do so, despite less expensive options from finding roommates to living with family.

After all, living alone allows us to do what we want, when we want, on our own terms. It liberates us from the restrictions of domestic partners needs and demands. Today, in our age of digital media and ever-expanding social networks, living alone can offer even greater benefits: the time and space for the healing power of aloneness.

This means that living alone can help us discover who we are and what gives us meaning and purpose. It might be exactly what we need to reconnect.

26. In 1950 living alone _____

- [A] was identified as the biggest social change.
- [B] was a temporary state for those who did so.
- [C] attracted 9% of American seasonal workers.
- [D] grew into the primary type of domestic life.

27. Today Americans who live alone _____.

- [A] expect to live in the Western states.
- [B] tend to maintain their way of life.
- [C] have a former marriage with kids.
- [D] are related with childless couples.

28. According to the latest studies, people living alone may _____.

- [A] be a burden on society.
- [B] feel lonelier than others.
- [C] come from split families.
- [D] engage in social activities.

29. It is indicated that living alone _____.

- [A] makes more demands on society.
- [B] imposes on one more restriction.
- [C] presents one with more challenges.
- [D] costs more than living with family.

30. The writer concludes that living alone enables us to _____.

[A] get help from others.

[B] know our true selves.

[C] set up social networks.

[D] reconnect with friends.

Text 2

If you've traveled by airplane in the past few years, chances are you've walked through a full body scanner at the security checkpoint.

The first generation of full body X-ray scanners rolled out in airports across the US in 2008. Known as backscatter scanners, there was a bit of an uproar from consumers when these came on the scene. Fliers feared the imaging would visually strip them of their clothes in front of the Transportation Security Administration (TSA) agents. Some health experts also worried that these models might expose people to unnecessary radiation.

But in 2013, the TSA replaced backscatter scanners with new-and-improved scanners, called millimeter wave screeners. They fixed the “see you naked” issue. These devices create a standard outline of a person, rather than a detailed image of the person's body. They're also an improvement for your health. The millimeter wave scanners use low power radio frequency waves to create the image. The frequency is the same as that used for Wi-Fi devices. If you stood for three seconds in a scanner, it would be no more radiation exposure than standing in front of your computer router at home. Backscatter scanners, meanwhile, can still be found in other places like jails and courthouses. They do expose people to small amounts of X-rays, but the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) considers them safe. A person receives more radiation from naturally occurring sources in less than an hour of ordinary living than from one screening with any general-use X-ray security system. Says the FDA. Yet others are not so convinced.

The European Union prohibits the backscatters. Some scientists believe that even very low-level X-ray exposure could increase the risk of cancer. “I would agree that the individual risk associated with X-ray scanners is likely to be extremely small, “says David Brenner, head of Columbia University's Center for Radiological Research. “The issue of concern is when the X-ray scanners are used in a very high-volume setting (just under a billion security screens occur each year in US airports). A very tiny risk multiplied by a billion has the potential to represent a public health issue.”

31. Air passengers were afraid that backscatter imaging would _____.
[A] delay their boarding [B] invade their privacy
[C] do harm to their health [D] cause a public uproar
32. The millimeter wave screener is now applied as it _____.
[A] reduces the health risk of scanning
[B] shows the details of a person's body
[C] uses a lower frequency than Wi-Fi devices
[D] exposes people to a fixed amount of X-rays
33. The FDA believes that the health risk of backscatter scanning _____.
[A] will be lowered [B] can be tolerated
[C] must be measured [D] should be avoided
34. David Brenner's remarks support the idea that _____.
[A] low level X-ray exposure may become a health concern
[B] exposure to X-rays is a common phenomenon in our life
[C] tiny risks may develop into big threats to traffic safety
[D] the European Union's ban of backscatters is an overreaction
35. What is the passage mainly about?
[A] The improvement of airport security.
[B] The significance of full body imaging.
[C] Uses of the millimeter wave screener.
[D] Health concerns about X-ray scanning.

Part B

Directions:

Read the texts from a magazine article in which five people talk about internet technology. For questions 36-40, match the name of each person to one of the statements (A-G) given below. Mark your answers on ANSWER SHEET.

Lucia Amour:

The internet is a positive influence on modern-day generations, keeping them informed on both local and global news quickly. It is the top source of news for 18- to 24-year-olds. It also helps people to form opinions from news and about others on their own. Lastly, it helps people to stay in touch with global causes that they would not be able to learn about without the use of the internet.

David Alex:

The internet both helps and hurts us, allowing us access to things previously thought to be impossible, not all good, but not all bad. You can make new friends, research any topic with only a few clicks, buy almost anything and communicate with other across long distances without any effort. It can also lead to bad things like cybercrime, being unsocial, and can make people believe things that aren't true.

Nelda Penn:

Internet technology has had an influence on mankind, whether it is good or bad. What we should realize is that there will always be people that feel the need to hurt others. We can't change this. However, we can learn from their actions and learn how to avoid the people who want to hurt us. We can't change the actions of those around us, but we can decide our actions.

Grace Hand:

Internet technology is an amazing thing that humans are relying on too much. People are becoming so dependent that the internet is hurting them in many ways. For one thing, many people don't turn to people for help but go on the internet. For another, the internet is making mankind really lazy. You can do almost everything on it except build relationships.

Louis Perry:

The internet has created a world without facts for our youth. Out of touch with real life, our children are open to connecting with strangers based on mutual interests. They are willing to trust strangers based on their online profiles, unaware that many people have a faked image on the internet that glorifies the things that they are doing in life when in fact they are not doing anything significant.

Now match each of the persons (36-40) to the appropriate statement.

Note: there are two extra statements.

Statements

- | | |
|-----------------|--|
| 36. Lucia Amour | [A] Self-protection is important in the age of the internet. |
| 37. David Alex | [B] With internet technology, people feel safer. |
| 38. Nelda Penn | [C] Internet technology has broadened people's horizons. |
| 39. Grace Hand | [D] The internet can lead to addiction and idleness. |

40. Louis Perry

[E] Socializing on the internet is not safe.

[F] The internet is really a mixed blessing.

[G] Internet technology has given our youth a fake image.

Part C

Directions:

Read the following text from which five sentences have been removed. Choose from the sentences A-G the most suitable one to fill each numbered gap in the text (41-45). There are TWO extra sentences that you do not need to use. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET

While more research is needed to strengthen the understanding of the link between gratitude and health, here's a roundup of some compelling reasons why you will want to be thankful.

You'll have a healthier heart: In a study of 186 people with heart damage, researchers rated their levels of gratitude and spiritual well-being. _____ 41 _____ They also found that having high levels of gratitude explained lots of the benefits of spiritual well-being.

You might get more shut eye: _____ 42 _____ A study of college students who were troubled by racing minds and worries found that those who were asked to spend 15 minutes in the early evening writing about a positive event that occurred recently could quiet their minds and sleep better.

It makes you more optimistic: _____ 43 _____ In a 2003 study, researchers had some people write about what they were grateful for, and some write about quarrels. After a few weeks, the researchers found that the people who wrote about positive things were more optimistic and felt better about themselves than the group that wrote about negative things.

Gratitude helps you make new friends: Expressing gratitude is a great way to build new relationships. In a 2014 study, researchers asked 70 college students to send comments on a college admissions essay by a high schooler. _____ 44 _____ Those who were thanked were more likely to provide the younger student with their personal information, like an email address.

Being thankful improves physical health: An analysis of nearly 1,000 adults found that higher levels of gratitude were associated with better self-reported

physical health. 45 Other researches have suggested that people who are grateful are more likely to do physical activities.

[A] Being thankful can contribute to a healthier and more positive outlook.

[B] Adults who maintain a conscious focus on gratitude have a warmer personality.

[C] The students then received a note from him that either expressed gratitude or did not.

[D] The people who felt more thankful had a notable willingness to take part in healthy behaviors.

[E] They found that higher gratitude scores were linked to having a better mood and higher quality sleep.

[F] If you're having difficulty sleeping, writing down what you are thankful for before bed can help.

[G] Some patients wrote down things they were grateful for over an eight-week period.

Part D

Directions:

Read the following text from which 10 words have been removed. Choose from the words A-O the most suitable one to fill each numbered gap in the text (46-55). There are FIVE extra words that you do not need to use. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

The desire to learn a new language is often born of a desire to find a deeper experience abroad

When traveling to a country with a language that's not native to your tongue, translation apps are 46, but only to a certain extent. They enable you to work out a menu, but not 47 to spark up a conversation with your server. Fluency in the local language makes for far more discovery potential.

Learning to speak a second language can be challenging, for sure, but that's because you're training your brain to do something much more 48 than

memorizing new words and their proper pronunciations. You're expanding your thought 49, in more ways than one.

Bilingualism provides benefits 50 the ability to ask for directions or to order a coffee without accidentally receiving a large dessert plate. The brains of bilingual people operate 51 than those of monolingual folks. Regular use of

a second language sharpens cognitive skills, and it's even been found to make you appear more attractive

To 52 these new language skills, there are tons of options: signing up for a class, downloading an app like Duolingo, or trying a more intensive software, like Rosetta Stone —which is offering a deal to save 40 percent on its complete Set 53 February 17. With any of these services, 54 is key. Consistently practicing —even if you dedicate just 15 minutes a day —is enough to reap the cognitive rewards that 55 second language learning.

- | | | |
|------------------|------------------|----------------|
| [A] obtain | [B] across | [C] helpful |
| [D] beyond | [E] complex | [F] train |
| [G] commitment | [H] differently | [I] accompany |
| [J] traditional | [K] necessarily | [L] capability |
| [M] intelligence | [N] respectfully | [O] until |

Section III Writing

(45 minutes)

Directions:

You should write your responses to both Part A and Part B of this section on ANSWER SHEET 2.

Part A

56. You have read a job posting online and want to apply for the job. Write an email to the company, and tell them about:

- 1) your interest in the job.
- 2) your qualifications for the position.
- 3) your past work experiences.

You should write about 100 words.

Do not sign your own name at the end of your email. Use “Wang Lin” instead.

Part B

57. Directions:

Read the text below. Write an essay in about 120 words, in which you should summarize the key points of the text and make comments on them. Try to use your own words.

A couple that has been married for 38 years and overcame difficult circumstances graduated from college together this month.

On Dec. 3th, their son, Charles Cole III, 33, posted a picture on the internet of his parents in their caps and gowns, which has gotten a ton of attention online.

Cole's parents, Charles Cole Jr. and Renate, battled major financial problems when he was young, which made for a rough childhood. "I grew up pretty early," he said. "I just knew I didn't want to go through what I saw them go through."

Cole graduated from California State University with a degree in political science and is now working towards a PhD in education. He has also worked as a social worker, developing a passion for work involving black youth and education.

Cole's parents were inspired by him to finish college. "Our son is ambitious," recalled Charles Cole Jr. "Seeing his drive to just do it kind of pushed us."

Cole is proud that his parents' journey was inspired by his own. "It crystalizes my work," he said. "How I grew up is part of the reason why I work really hard to fight for education for black and brown kids across this country because I know what the results are if you don't have it."

For Cole, his parents have proven to him that you can always get back what you think you have lost, "Just because you started slow doesn't mean you can't finish up strong." He said.

THAT IS THE END OF THE TEST